

My Grounding Menu

Choose methods that help you become more present, not methods you are 'supposed' to like.

Early signs that I may need grounding:

External orientation

- ☐ Name the date, place, and what I am doing
- ☐ Describe five neutral things I can see
- ☐ Read signs, labels, or a short paragraph
- ☐ Listen for three separate sounds
- ☐ Name what is different from the memory or fear

Touch and movement

- ☐ Feet on the floor
- ☐ Notice the chair or wall supporting me
- ☐ Hold an object and describe its texture or weight
- ☐ Stretch or change position
- ☐ Walk and notice each step

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Thinking tasks

- ☐ Count objects
- ☐ Name items in a category
- ☐ Spell a familiar word backward
- ☐ Describe the next three steps of a routine
- ☐ Do a simple mental task that is absorbing but not frustrating

Connection

- ☐ Hear a trusted person's voice
- ☐ Text or call someone
- ☐ Sit near another person without needing to talk
- ☐ Use a familiar object, photo, pet, or place

The three grounding methods most likely to work for me:

Grounding methods I do NOT want used with me:

A sentence that helps orient me to the present:

If grounding is not enough, my next step is:

Remember. Grounding is allowed to be individualized. If breath focus, closed eyes, touch, cold, or body scanning increases distress, use another route.